

HARIAKSHA GUNDA

Curriculum Vitae

United States | hgunda@crimson.ua.edu | hariaksha.com

EDUCATION

The University of Alabama

B.S. IN DATA SCIENCE

Tuscaloosa, AL

08/2022 – 05/2027

- Minors: Mathematics, Computer Science, Economics
- Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Non-Linear Optimization Theory, Real Analysis I-II, Machine Learning, Database Management Systems
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

The University of Alabama

B.A. IN FOREIGN LANGUAGES AND LITERATURE

Tuscaloosa, AL

08/2022 – 05/2027

- Concentration: German Language and Literature
- Minors: International Studies, Public Policy Studies, Global and Cultural Perspectives
- Relevant Coursework: Issues in Global Governance, Environmental Decision-Making, International Social Work, American Public Policy
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, UA Culverhouse College of Business

01/2024 – Present

Research Assistant, The University of Chicago

06/2026 – 07/2026

Visiting Researcher, Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy

05/2025 - 08/2025

Data Scientist, Planet Indonesia International

12/2024 - 04/2025

Research Assistant, UA Digital Forensics and Cyber Security Lab

08/2023 - 12/2023

Data Scientist, Alabama Department of Public Health Center for Health Statistics

05/2023 - 06/2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

Ambassador, Institute for Economics and Peace

04/2026 – Present

Scholarship (7x, applied each semester), Zeta Psi Educational Foundation

01/2023 – 03/2026

REAL List: Global and Intercultural Learning Top 25, The University of Alabama

12/2025

Microsoft Emerging Leader, Microsoft Security

04/2025 – Present

Gilman Scholars Brussels EU Study Tour Selection, US Department of State

06/2025

National Award for Undergraduates of German, German National Honor Society

04/2025

Gilman Research Scholarship, US Department of State

12/2024 - 08/2025

Boren Scholarship, US Department of Defense

04/2024 - 04/2025

Outstanding Cultural Organization, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club)

04/2024

Critical Language Scholarship, US Department of State (declined)

03/2024

Excellence Second-Year, University of Alabama German Department

04/2023

Best Event Award, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club Mock Shaadi)

04/2023

Children of Associates Premier Scholarship (3x), H&R Block

09/2022 – 09/2023

Crimson Scholar, The University of Alabama

08/2022 – 05/2024

National Merit Finalist Scholarship, National Merit Scholarship Corporation

04/2022

PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

World Congress on Undergraduate Research (WorldCUR), Zayed University, Dubai, United Arab Emirates (accepted). January 2027. *Smoke and Strife: Wind-Instrumented Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia*

Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy Brown Bag Seminar. August 2025. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

Planet Indonesia International Intern Symposium. April 2025. *Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces using Data on Ecology and Socio-economic and Environmental Resilience*

State University of Malang Student Seminars. December 2024. *Assessment of Marine Environmental Risks in Indonesia*

Poster Presentations

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Heat Is On: Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Conflict Probability and Intensity in Indonesia*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. March 2024. *The Impact of Linguistic Features on Revenues using NLP on Mission Statements of Tax-Exempt Organizations*

CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIAL LEARNING

Documenting Development Data Using Metadata Standards , The World Bank Group	08/2026
Responsible AI in a Global Context , United Nations University	07/2026
How Tech Drives Sustainability , LinkedIn Learning	06/2026
IEP Ambassador Seminars , Institute for Economics and Peace	05/2026
Positive Peace Academy , Institute for Economics and Peace	02/2026
Microsoft Emerging Leader Professional Development Series , Microsoft Security	08/2025
Climate Catalysts Mentorship Program , UNFCCC	05/2025
Becoming a Climate Champion , UNITAR	04/2025
Digital4Sustainability Learning Path , UNSSC	03/2025
Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification , DeepLearning.AI	02/2025
AI For Everyone , DeepLearning.AI	01/2024
Cybersecurity Foundations Specialization , InfoSEC	05/2023
Python Essential Training , LinkedIn Learning	11/2022

PROJECTS

The University of Alabama CO-INVESTIGATOR WITH DR. MICHAEL PRICE • Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Social Unrest in Indonesia	01/2026 – Present <i>Working Paper</i>
The University of Chicago, The University of Alabama, The University of Toronto RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. JOHN LIST, DR. MICHAEL PRICE, AND DR. ANGELA DOKU • Sentiment Analysis of Climate Disaster News Articles in the USA	10/2025 – Present <i>Working Paper</i>
The University of Alabama RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. MICHAEL PRICE • Impact of Mission Statement Linguistic Features on Nonprofit Revenues	01/2024 – 05/2024 <i>No longer active</i>
ZEW Mannheim, The University of Alabama RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. MARTIN KESTERNICH AND DR. MICHAEL PRICE • The Effects of GDPR on Firm Behavior and Innovation	05/2025 – 08/2025 <i>No longer active</i>
Planet Indonesia International DATA SCIENTIST WITH ADAM MILLER • Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces	12/2024 – 04/2025 <i>Completed</i>

EXTRACURRICULARS AND AFFILIATIONS

Research Ambassador , UA Office of Undergraduate Research	04/2026 – 05/2027
Member , Blue Key Honor Society	04/2026 – Present
Member , Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society	04/2026 – Present

Member , Pi Mu Epsilon, the National Honor Society for Mathematics	04/2026 – Present
Member , UA Philomathic Literary Society	03/2026 – 05/2027
Member , UA Education Abroad Alumni Association	03/2026 – Present
President , United Nations Association of the USA at UA	08/2025 – 05/2026
Technology Mechanisms Working Group Member , UNFCCC YOUNGO	06/2025 – Present
Member , United Nations Association of the USA	06/2025 – 06/2026
Member , Asian Environmental Youth Network	06/2025 – Present
Data Volunteer , Oxford Net Zero Tracker	05/2025 – Present
Member , Delta Phi Alpha (German National Honor Society)	05/2024 – Present
Member , National Security Education Program (NSEP) Alumni Association	05/2024 – Present
Honors College Ambassador , UA Honors College	03/2024 – 05/2027
Scholarship Officer , Zeta Psi International Fraternity	01/2023 – 05/2027
Member , Golden Key Honor Society	09/2022 – Present
Secretary & Advisor , UA South Asian Culture Club	08/2022 – 05/2027
Member , Association for Computing Machinery	08/2022 – Present
Member , Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers	08/2022 – Present
Member , UA German Club	08/2022 – 05/2027
Choreographer, Teacher, Dancer , Nach Basanti (Indian fusion dance team)	08/2022 – 05/2027

FEATURED

Podcasts

Put the Guidebook Down. April 2026. *Speaking the Place: How Language Changes the Way You Travel*

Put the Guidebook Down. December 2025. *The Power of a Gap Year: Breaking Out of the Linear Life Path*

Datasets

Oxford Net Zero Tracker. September 2025. *Net Zero Stocktake 2025*

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Python, Econometrics, Field Experiments, R, SQL, MATLAB, TensorFlow, Webscraping, Database Management, Git, HTML/CSS/JS, LaTeX, Stata, QGIS

Languages: *German* (CEFR B1: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Indonesian* (ACTFL 2: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Malay* (Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Telugu* (Basic)